

Nikos Pagonas

Contact

Email: nikospagonas00@gmail.com — Website: nikpag.github.io

Education

Columbia University

PhD in Computer Science

Advisor: Prof. [Kostis Kaffes](#)

GPA: 3.94/4.00

Member of [DAPLab](#), focusing on systems for agentic AI. My research focuses on improving the performance and efficiency of agentic serving. I build systems that exploit workflow structure and runtime characteristics to optimize model routing, scheduling, and resource allocation.

Sep 2024 – Present

New York, NY, US

National Technical University of Athens (NTUA)

Master of Electrical and Computer Engineering

Advisors: Prof. [Nikos Vasilakis](#), Prof. [Georgios Goumas](#)

GPA: 9.39/10.00 (14th out of 344 students)

Thesis: “*SPLASH: Scaling Out Shell Scripts on Serverless Platforms*”

Oct 2018 – Jun 2024

Athens, Greece

Experience

Google

Student Researcher

Supervisor: Prof. [Arvind Krishnamurthy](#)

Designed and implemented [Cortex](#), a prototype agentic serving platform that leverages workflow-awareness and stage isolation to improve scheduling and KV cache efficiency in agentic NL2SQL workflows.

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Sunnyvale, CA, US

Brown University

Student Researcher

Advisor: Prof. [Nikos Vasilakis](#)

Contributed to [PASH](#), an open-source [Linux Foundation](#) project. Worked on improving the performance of shell scripts by running them on serverless infrastructure, and providing fault tolerance for distributed shell script execution.

Sep 2023 – May 2024

Providence, RI, US

Arrikto Inc.

Software Engineering Intern

Supervisor: [Vangelis Koukis](#)

Explored how to serve PyTorch models more efficiently through KServe, a highly scalable machine learning deployment platform for Kubernetes.

Dec 2022 – Mar 2023

Athens, Greece

Awards	Columbia University Presidential Fellowship	2024 – Present
	A.G. Leventis Foundation Scholarship	2025 – Present
	Gerondelis Foundation Scholarship	2025
	ACM SOSP 2025 Student Travel Grant	2025
Publications	AgentOpt v0.1 Technical Report: Client-Side Optimization for LLM-Based Agents Wenyue Hua, Sripad Karne, Qian Xie, Armaan Agrawal, Nikos Pagonas, Kostis Kaffes, Tianyi Peng	
	VineLM: Trie-Based Fine-Grained Control for Agentic Workflows Nikos Pagonas, Matthew Lou, Tianyi Peng, Dan Rubenstein, Kostis Kaffes	
	Cortex: Workflow-Aware Resource Pooling and Scheduling for Agentic Serving Nikos Pagonas, Yeounoh Chung, Kostis Kaffes, Arvind Krishnamurthy <i>SOSP 2025 Workshop on Systems for Agentic AI (SAA 2025)</i>	
	leash: Scaling Out Shell Scripts with Reliable Cloud Computing <i>(Under Submission)</i>	
Service	EuroSys 2026	2026
	Artifact Evaluation Committee	
	SOSP 2025	2025
	<i>Artifact Evaluation Committee</i>	
	OSDI 2025	2025
	Artifact Evaluation Committee	
Teaching	ATC 2025	2025
	Artifact Evaluation Committee	
	EuroSec 2024	2024
	Web and Publication Chair	
	Columbia University	Fall 2025
	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> Course: Networks, Crowds, and the Web Professor: Augustin Chaintreau	New York, NY, US
	Columbia University	Spring 2025
	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> Course: Agentic Systems Made Real Professors: Eugene Wu , Kostis Kaffes	New York, NY, US

Brown University Fall 2024
Teaching Assistant Providence, RI, US
Course: [Systems Transforming Systems](#)
Professor: [Nikos Vasilakis](#)
Guided students through a systems research project, including implementation, evaluation, and paper writing. Paper submitted to USENIX ATC 2025.

Brown University Spring 2024
Teaching Assistant Providence, RI, US
Course: [Distributed Systems](#)
Professor: [Nikos Vasilakis](#)
Helped revamp the course by redesigning its semester-long project and implementing its autograding infrastructure from scratch.

National Technical University of Athens Spring 2022
Lab Assistant Athens, Greece
Course: Operating Systems
Professors: [N. Koziris](#), [G. Goumas](#)

National Technical University of Athens Spring 2020
Lab Assistant Athens, Greece
Course: Programming Techniques
Professors: [N. Papaspyrou](#), [A. Pagourtzis](#), [G. Stamou](#), [G. Goumas](#)

National Technical University of Athens Fall 2019
Lab Assistant Athens, Greece
Course: Introduction to Programming
Professors: [N. Papaspyrou](#), [D. Fotakis](#), [S. Zachos](#)

Research [Grace Li](#) Sep 2025 – Present
Mentoring *Columbia University, BS in CS and Math*

[Matthew Lou](#) Sep 2025 – Present
Columbia University, BS in CS and Applied Math

[Joey Huang](#) Sep 2025 – Dec 2025
Columbia University, BS in CS

Skills
Prog. Languages Python, C, Shell, Javascript, Java, Go
Frameworks LangChain, LangGraph
Platforms AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Apache Kafka, Apache Spark
Tools Git, LaTeX

Languages	English	Fluent — TOEFL iBT 116/120 (C2)
	Greek	Native